JISC × EDUFACE · WEBINAR

The business outcomes of AI marking and feedback

Lessons from 20+ pilots and implementations



TODAY

Four parts



In conversation with Jisc

What we learned in 20+ implementations

Breakout rooms: you choose

Consistency or Efficiency

Wrap-up together

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IN CONVERSATION

Hannah Lawrence

Licence Manager, Jisc



What does the sector expect from AI feedback,
and what is actually working?

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What do you see institutions struggling with most right now when it comes to AI?

What made Jisc decide to start the AI in marking and feedback pilot?

CONTEXT

38

colleges and universities in Jisc's AI in marking and feedback pilot

September 2025 to August 2026

> These tools shouldn't be used as a final marker. Humans should always be reviewing the feedback.
>
> **Tom Moule, Jisc**

Jisc National Centre for AI, May 2026 · Times Higher Education, 27 March 2026

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The pilot points towards formative feedback. What makes AI so valuable there?

Where do institutions tend to get stuck when they try it?

What's one piece of advice you'd give an institution starting next term?

WHAT WE LEARNED

Lessons from 20+ pilots and implementations

HOGESCHOOL ROTTERDAM

THE HAGUE UNIVERSITY OF APPLIED SCIENCES

TILBURG UNIVERSITY

Radboud University

Universiteit Leiden

Bath Spa

7th logo

+20

pilots & implementations

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This is not a product demo.
These are the patterns we saw.

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WHY INSTITUTIONS BRING US IN

Three reasons

1



Data risk

Staff already use AI to mark, outside policy

2



Consistency

Grading and feedback, formative and summative

3



Efficiency

Time back for lecturers

1 · DATA RISK

Staff are already using AI to mark

When it reaches the press,
it is no longer an IT issue.

OMROEP BRABANT · EARLY 2026

Docent bouwt AI-tool die studentgegevens naar ChatGPT stuurt

Lecturer builds AI tool that sends student data to ChatGPT

THE NEW YORK TIMES · MAY 2025

The Professors Are Using ChatGPT, and Some Students Aren't Happy About It

omroepbrabant.nl/nieuws/6002910 · nytimes.com, 14 May 2025

Banning it doesn't stop it.
A safe alternative does.

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01

Consistency

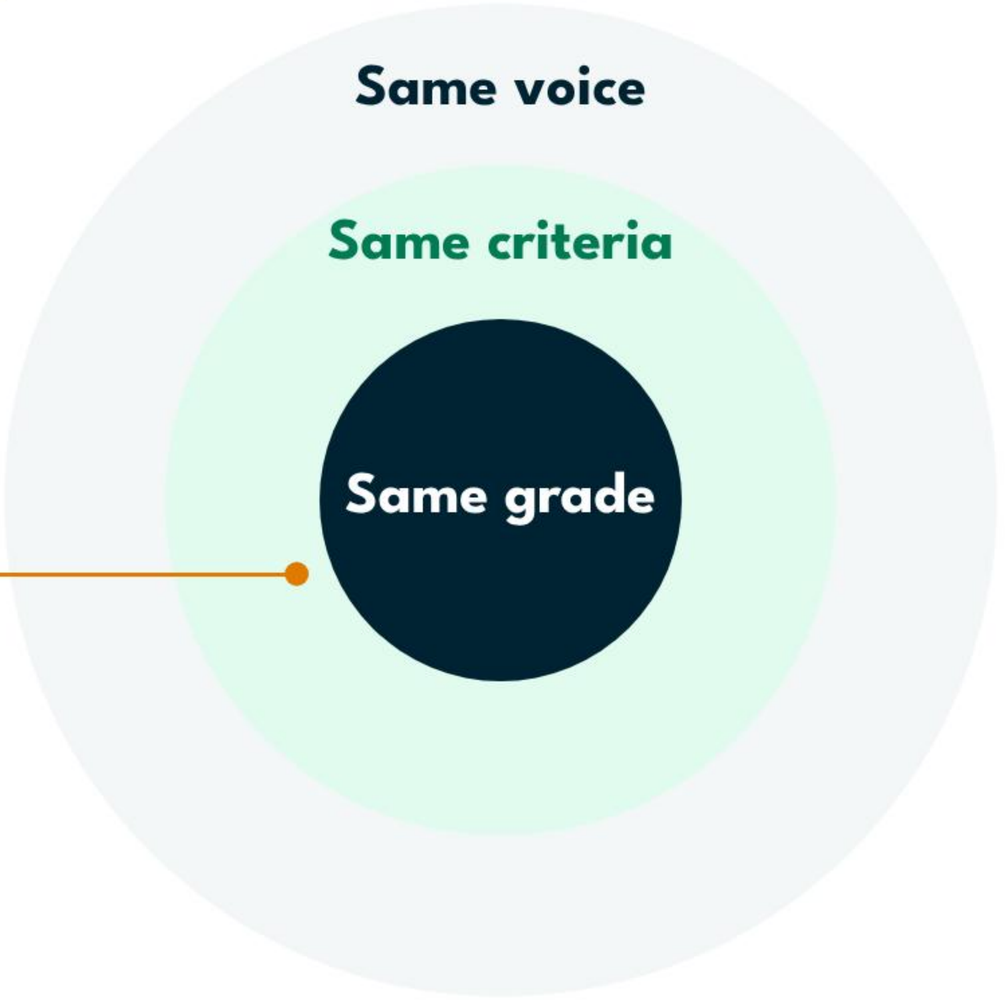
Grading and feedback, formative and summative

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CONSISTENCY

Consistency is more than the same grade

> Where most evaluations stop:
> run it twice, compare the mark.

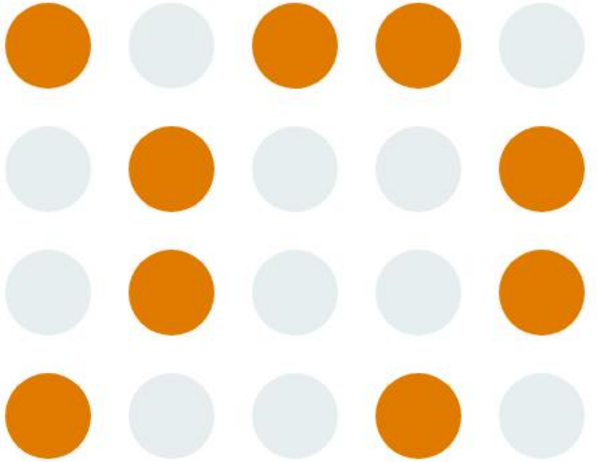


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THE PROBLEM IS OLD

9 of 20

assignments were ranked both best and worst by different experienced examiners



Same work, opposite rankings

Bloxham et al., Assessment & Evaluation in Higher Education, 2016 · 24 examiners, 20 UK universities

CONSISTENCY

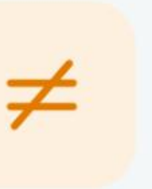
Where inconsistency hurts



Many markers, one module



Paper 80 is marked differently from paper 5



Students compare, then appeal



Moderation only sees a sample

WHY IT MATTERS TO US

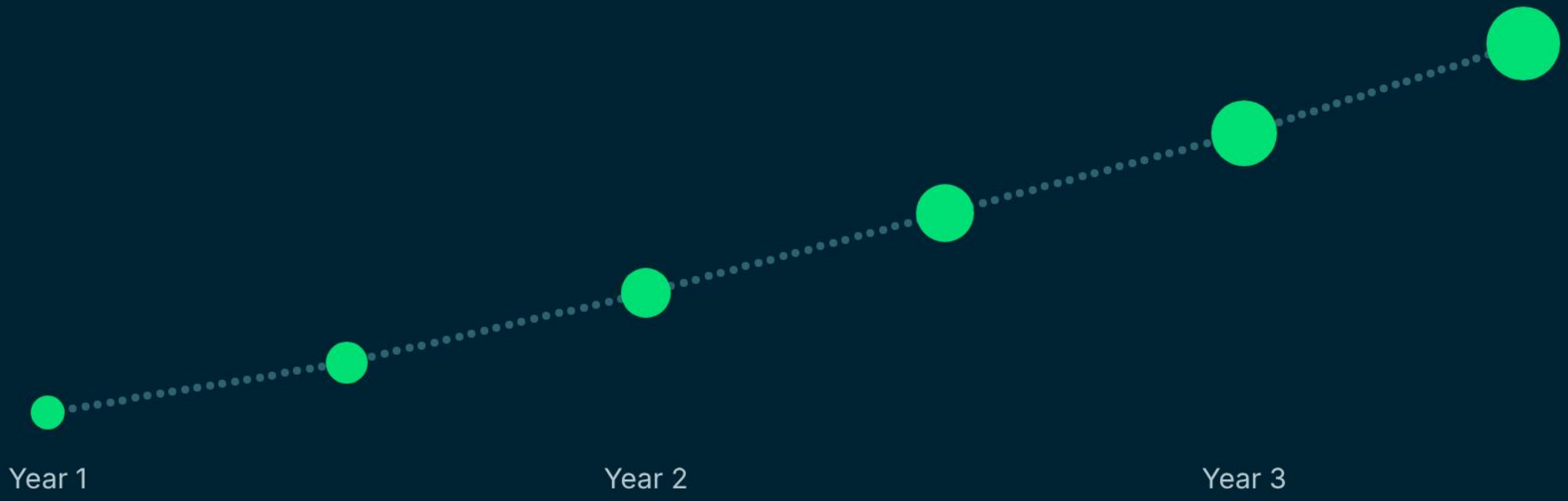
Consistent feedback can build on itself



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WHERE WE WANT TO GET TO

A student sees their own growth across the degree



Illustration

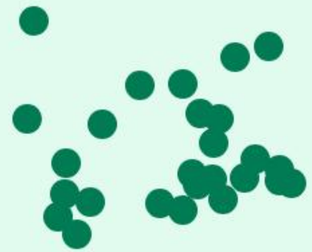
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OUR LESSON

We started with general LLMs. Then we built our own model.

General LLM

Same paper, different focus each run



Purpose-built model

Same paper, same criteria, same voice

Illustration, not a measurement. Model trained on 250,000 education-specific feedback examples.

WHAT INSTITUTIONS LEARNED

Two lessons on consistency



The gap was in the rubric, not in the markers

Six markers, one module. One marked “critical analysis” lower every time: they read the descriptor differently.



Students act on feedback they recognise

Three formative rounds, a different focus each time: students ignored it. Same criteria every round: they used it.

Typical scenarios from our implementations, institutions not named.

WHEN AI GRADING IS A STEP TOO FAR

Not ready for AI grades? Use it to moderate.



AI grade stays hidden. Only large deviations reach the moderator.

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02

Operational efficiency

Time saved on marking and feedback

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EFFICIENCY

Two flavours

Formative

03:00

Student asks for feedback
when it suits them

No human in the loop

Summative

Lecturer + AI

Time saved on writing,
not on reading

Human in the loop

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WHERE THE TIME GOES

Academics already work far beyond contract



UCU workload survey, 2016, n ≈ 12,100 (older data)

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WHAT WE HEAR FROM INSTITUTIONS

The cost of no time

FOR LECTURERS

- Marking instead of mentoring
- Structural overtime

FOR INSTITUTIONS

- No formative feedback at all
- Paying external markers
- Fewer staff, more students

WHY ACCURACY MATTERS TO US

Time saved depends on accuracy



Your rubric and instructions → The model follows them → Feedback you would give → **Approve, don't rewrite**

Inaccurate feedback costs more time to fix than to write yourself.

OUR LESSONS

Tuning is the investment

~6

points from the lecturer's mark, on average

~2

points for lecturers who tuned the model

2–3

minutes review time per submission

One pilot, Bath Spa University, June 2026: 435 submissions, 6 modules, 13 markers.

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WHERE WE WANT TO GET TO

Lecturer time moves from typing to teaching



Illustration, not a measurement.

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“Won’t lecturers just click approve?”

The question we always get.

OUR ANSWER

Approving is still judging



The alternative today is often no feedback at all



It gives the feedback the lecturer set up



Every edit is logged in the audit trail

The AI assists. The academic decides.

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BREAKOUT ROOMS

Choose your room



Consistency

with Dante



Operational efficiency

with [name]

Statements · vote · discuss · short talk · questions

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ROOM · CONSISTENCY

Agree or disagree?

1	Same grade with different feedback is consistent enough.	Agree	Disagree
2	Students care more about fair grades than consistent feedback.	Agree	Disagree
3	AI should flag unusual marks, not propose them.	Agree	Disagree

ROOM · OPERATIONAL EFFICIENCY

Agree or disagree?

1	Formative feedback no lecturer has read first is acceptable.	Agree	Disagree
2	Time saved on marking will be cut, not given back to students.	Agree	Disagree
3	Approving AI feedback with small edits is still my feedback.	Agree	Disagree

BACK TOGETHER

What we heard

Consistency

Operational efficiency

Which of these would you test first?

Slides and sources follow by email.

info@eduface.me · eduface.me

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